

PLC
AGENDA

Critical Thinking & Facilitation

Protect the key thinking in the lesson and plan how every student will engage in it.

FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 11, 2026

46 MINUTES

GRADES 9–12 SCIENCE • BRING THE SAME LESSON FORWARD

TODAY'S OUTCOME Leave with the same lesson strengthened by a key-thinking moment, anticipated student responses, facilitation moves, access supports, and a plan for collecting student evidence.

WHY THIS PLC MATTERS When teachers anticipate strong, partial, and emerging responses before teaching, feedback and access supports are ready before students become stuck—and the cognitive work stays with students.

PROTOCOL FOCUS

Lesson Internalization Tool — Every Day Question 3 and Team Deep Dive Step 4: plan for critical thinking, facilitation, access, and engagement.

WHAT TO BRING

The lesson plan from September 8; mastery task/exemplar; student materials; Lesson Internalization Tool; notes about student strengths, needs, and likely misconceptions.

FOCUS TO PROTECT

Protect reasoning, not task completion. Plan questions, feedback, discourse, and supports that let students do the grade-level thinking themselves.

TODAY'S PLC PLAN

TIME (MIN)	FOCUS	WHAT TO DO	PRODUCT / CHECK
0:00–5:00	Welcome & reconnect	Bring forward the purpose-and-mastery plan. Identify the task that will show the learning you named.	Shared lesson context
5:00–13:00	Find key thinking	Locate the question or task where students must explain, model, compare, analyze, or argue from evidence—not only recall or follow steps.	Key-thinking moment
13:00–21:00	Anticipate responses	Use the exemplar to name likely strong, partial, and emerging responses and the evidence each would show.	Response anticipation notes
21:00–30:00	Plan facilitation & access	Plan questions, feedback that prompts action, academic discourse, and supports that maintain the learning goal.	Facilitation + access moves
30:00–41:00	Protected team planning	Use the protocol with a course-alike team or co-teaching partner. Complete the numbered work steps below.	Facilitation plan
41:00–46:00	Reflection & preview	Write: What will you listen and look for during the key thinking moment?	Evidence-to-collect note

PROTECTED COLLABORATIVE WORK**WORK
WITH
COLLEAGUES**

WHAT TO DO Complete these steps with your course-alike team or co-teaching partner.

- 1. Locate the key thinking:** Name the task/question where students must reason, explain, model, analyze, or argue from evidence.
 - 2. Anticipate what students may say:** Use the exemplar to identify likely strong, partial, and emerging responses; name the evidence students may use.
 - 3. Plan facilitation:** Draft questions, feedback, and a student-to-student discourse move that keep the cognitive work with students.
 - 4. Plan access and evidence:** Choose one language, representation, participation, or flexible support; name what you will listen/look for during the task.
- ✓ **Completion check:** Each team adds a usable facilitation plan to the September 8 lesson, including key thinking, anticipated responses, access supports, and evidence to collect.

USE THIS REFERENCE DURING GROUP WORK

KEY THINKING Locate the question or task where students must reason, explain, model, analyze, or argue from evidence—not simply recall or follow a procedure.	PLAN BEFORE TEACHING Anticipate strong, partial, and emerging responses. Draft the questions, feedback, discourse move, and one access support that keep the thinking with students.	CARRY FORWARD Bring the same lesson and facilitation plan to September 14 for rehearsal, peer feedback, and a ready-to-teach refinement.
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COLLABORATION IN PRACTICE Collaborate with respect and precision: assume competence, use asset-based language about students, invite multiple perspectives, and offer feedback that helps a colleague take a specific next action.

Classroom Teacher Model Rubric Connection — Standard II: II-A-1 Quality of Effort and Work • II-A-2 Student Engagement • II-D-3 Access to Knowledge